GRADE 9 AGRICULTURE
CONTINUOUS ASSESSMENT TEST 1

TERM 1 | TIME: 1 HOUR 15 MINUTES | TOTAL: 50 MARKS

Name: ____ Adm. No.: _______________

School: _______________________________________ Date: ____________________

INSTRUCTIONS

- Answer all questions.
- Write your answers clearly.
- Use labelled diagrams where necessary.
- The marks for each question are shown in brackets.

SECTION A: SHORT-ANSWER QUESTIONS (20 MARKS)

1. Define the term soil fertility. (2 marks)

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2. State TWO ways in which organic matter improves soil. (2 marks)

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3. Differentiate between soil texture and soil structure. (2 marks)

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4. Name TWO signs that may indicate nutrient deficiency in a crop. (2 marks)

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5. State TWO factors to consider when selecting a suitable site for a crop enterprise. (2 marks)

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6. Give TWO examples of farm records and state one use of each. (2 marks)

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7. State TWO benefits of crop rotation. (2 marks)

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8. Identify TWO methods of controlling weeds in a crop field. (2 marks)

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9. Explain why seeds should be obtained from a reliable source. (2 marks)

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10. State TWO safety precautions to observe when using farm tools. (2 marks)

SECTION B: STRUCTURED QUESTIONS (30 MARKS)

11. Soil management (8 marks)

(a) Describe THREE ways of conserving soil on a sloping farm. (3 marks)

(b) Explain TWO benefits of adding well-decomposed compost to a vegetable garden. (4 marks)

(c) State ONE reason for avoiding cultivation when soil is excessively wet. (1 mark)

12. Crop establishment (8 marks)

(a) Outline FOUR steps involved in preparing a seedbed. (4 marks)

(b) Distinguish between direct sowing and transplanting. (2 marks)

(c) State TWO reasons for watering newly transplanted seedlings. (2 marks)

13. Crop health and field management (7 marks)

(a) Differentiate between a pest and a crop disease. (2 marks)

(b) State THREE cultural practices that can reduce pest or disease incidence. (3 marks)

(c) Give TWO reasons for removing weeds before they produce seeds. (2 marks)

14. Farm planning and safety (7 marks)

(a) State THREE reasons why a farmer should keep farm records. (3 marks)

(b) Explain TWO ways of maintaining farm tools. (2 marks)

(c) State TWO precautions to take when storing farm chemicals. (2 marks)

MARKING SCHEME – GRADE 9 AGRICULTURE CAT 1

Total: 50 marks

SECTION A: SHORT-ANSWER QUESTIONS (20 MARKS)

1. The ability of soil to supply essential plant nutrients in adequate amounts and suitable balance for healthy crop growth. (2)

2. Any TWO: improves soil structure; increases water-holding capacity; supports soil organisms; adds nutrients; reduces erosion when incorporated as mulch/cover. (1 each)

3. Texture is the relative proportion of sand, silt and clay particles; structure is the arrangement of soil particles into aggregates/peds. (1 each)

4. Any TWO: yellowing/chlorosis; stunted growth; purple or discoloured leaves; poor flowering/fruiting; leaf scorching or premature leaf fall. (1 each)

5. Any TWO: soil type/fertility; water availability/drainage; sunlight; slope/topography; access to roads/markets; security; space and land-use suitability. (1 each)

6. Any TWO correct pairs, e.g. sales record – tracks income; expense record – tracks costs; planting record – records crop/planting dates; input record – tracks seed/fertiliser use; labour record – tracks work done. (1 each)

7. Any TWO: breaks pest and disease cycles; maintains/improves soil fertility; improves soil structure; helps manage weeds; diversifies farm produce. (1 each)

8. Any TWO: hand weeding; hoeing; mulching; crop rotation; timely cultivation; approved herbicide use according to label and safety guidance. (1 each)

9. Reliable seed is more likely to be viable, true to type, healthy and free from weed seeds or seed-borne pests/diseases. Award up to 2 marks for relevant explanation.

10. Any TWO: use the correct tool; inspect for damage; wear suitable protective gear; carry sharp tools safely; keep tools away from children; clean and store tools after use. (1 each)

SECTION B: STRUCTURED QUESTIONS (30 MARKS)

11. Soil management

(a) Any THREE, 1 mark each: contour ploughing; terracing; strip cropping; planting grass strips; maintaining vegetative cover; agroforestry; constructing appropriate water channels.

(b) Any TWO explained, 2 marks each: adds nutrients; improves soil structure; increases water retention; encourages beneficial soil organisms; improves aeration when soil structure is poor.

(c) Wet soil is easily compacted and its structure may be damaged; accept equivalent explanation. (1)

12. Crop establishment

(a) Any FOUR, 1 mark each: clear vegetation/debris; remove stones and perennial weeds; dig or plough soil; break large clods; level the seedbed; incorporate suitable organic matter; form beds/ridges where appropriate.

(b) Direct sowing: seeds are planted at the final growing site. Transplanting: young seedlings are raised elsewhere then moved to the field. (1 each)

(c) Any TWO: reduces transplant shock; helps roots establish; prevents wilting; settles soil around roots. (1 each)

13. Crop health and field management

(a) Pest: an organism that damages crops; disease: an abnormal condition caused by pathogens or other factors that disrupts normal plant function. (1 each)

(b) Any THREE: crop rotation; field sanitation; timely planting; use of healthy planting material; proper spacing; resistant varieties; removal of infected plants; intercropping where suitable. (1 each)

(c) Prevents weeds from producing and spreading seeds; reduces competition for light, water, nutrients and space. (1 each)

14. Farm planning and safety

(a) Any THREE: monitor profit/loss; plan purchases and production; track yields and sales; support budgeting; help make decisions; provide evidence for loans/assessments. (1 each)

(b) Any TWO explained: clean and dry after use to prevent rust; sharpen cutting edges; oil moving parts; repair/replace loose handles; store in a dry secure place. (1 each)

(c) Any TWO: keep in original labelled containers; lock in a secure ventilated store; keep away from food, feed, children and water sources; follow label instructions; separate incompatible products; use protective equipment when handling. (1 each)

Teacher's note: This is original teacher-prepared assessment material. Confirm that the relevant content has been taught before administering the test. Accept other scientifically and agriculturally correct responses.